

Topic 2: Chorale

Students must learn how to harmonise a chorale in the manner of J.S. Bach, by adding alto, tenor and bass parts to a given soprano in 4/4 time. Building on the harmonic vocabulary required for Unit 3, Section C, they need to be familiar with triads in root position and first inversion, the tonic triad in second inversion in contexts where Bach would have used it, seventh chords and inversions typical of Bach's style. They must also learn about other harmonic and voice-leading features and procedures typical of Bach's style, including modulation to closely-related keys, passing notes, and suspensions.

Topic 3: Popular song

Students must learn how to complete a two-part texture (without lyrics) from a popular song in ballad song style, with a lyrical melody, regular chord changes of one or more per bar, and modulation(s). They must know both how to add a melody part in passage(s) where the bass and chord symbols are given, and also how to supply the bass part and chord symbols where the melody part is given. The harmonic vocabulary expected will include triads, seventh chords (dominant, minor, major, diminished and half-diminished), and their inversions, simple added-note chords (such as C6) and sus. chords, and a knowledge of modulation is required. Students must be familiar with the necessary structural conventions (verse, chorus, pre-chorus, middle section).

3 Technical study

The technical study document will give candidates sufficient material to enable them to complete passage(s) in the styles described below. The given material for each exercise will consist of the complete texture for the opening (not less than one bar, not more than four bars) and at least one part thereafter throughout the exercise. Exercises may be in major or minor keys with up to four sharps or flats.

Topic 1: Baroque counterpoint

Candidates must complete a piece (or excerpt from a piece) for a melody instrument (violin or flute, as specified) plus bass with figuring in early 18th-century style. They must add, in an appropriate style, the melody part where bass and figuring only are given, **and** the bass part and figuring in passage(s) where the melody part only is given. The music to be added will normally be between 50 and 60 crotchet beats long (or equivalent if in a compound time).

Topic 2: Chorale

Candidates must harmonise, in the manner of J.S. Bach, a chorale (or a passage from or in the style of a chorale), by adding alto, tenor and bass parts to a given soprano. The music to be added will normally be between 8 and 10 bars long. Modal chorales, and chorales in 3/4 time, will not be set.

Topic 3: Popular song

Candidates must complete a popular song or an extract from one. The opening of the melody part (without lyrics) and the bass part (with chord symbols — eg E7, Gm) will be given. Candidates must add the melody part in passage(s) where the bass and chord symbols are given, and the bass part and chord symbols where the melody part is given. The music to be added will normally be between 18 and 20 bars long and may feature any or all of the following: verse, chorus, pre-chorus, middle section. The extract will be in ballad song style, with a lyrical melody and regular chord changes of one or more per bar, and will include modulation(s).

Each technical study will be marked out of 40 against the assessment criteria in *Section 5.7*.

4 Controlled conditions

Students have a maximum of 14 hours to complete each composition, and a maximum of 3 hours to complete each technical study. The hours may be divided into any number of sessions but each session must be supervised.

Supervision must take place within the examination centre and students must work on their composition/technical study only in and during these hours. At other times students' work must be kept under secure conditions in the centre.

Students must not take their composition/technical study home or anywhere else outside the room(s) in which the controlled conditions apply.

Students' access to any instruments or computers must be monitored by the supervisor. Students must not download material from the internet, or email their compositions home or anywhere else outside the room(s) in which the controlled conditions apply. Back-up copies of the work for Unit 5 must not be taken out of the room(s) in which the controlled conditions apply.

All students should be advised by their teacher that students' work must be their own, and that they will not sign the declaration form if the work appears not to be original. All students will also be required to sign a declaration form, stating that the work is their own.

Note: Students may have access to the anthology whilst completing their composition/technical study.

Note: Recordings of compositions for submission can take place outside the 14 hours. Students may find that they discover areas of their composition that need refining as a result of the performance/recording process. However, no further refining of compositions can take place as a result of the performance/recording after the 14 hours have elapsed.

More guidance on the management of controlled conditions is provided in the 'Getting Started' guide book.

5 Items for submission

1. Composition

For each composition completed:

- 1) A detailed notated score* appropriate to the style of music submitted. This must be submitted on manuscript paper or as a printout. Each student's score should be clearly labelled with their details.
- 2) A recording of the piece on audio CD or MiniDisc™. (Please note that long-play MiniDisc™ recordings are not acceptable.) The recording can be made live, be studio-produced or can be a MIDI 'mock up'.

Each student's work should be on a separate audio CD or MiniDisc™, clearly labelled with their details. Centres are requested to use one recording format for all their students' submissions — audio CD or MiniDisc™.

2. Technical study

For each technical study completed:

- 1) A completed technical study score must be submitted. Each student's score should be clearly labelled with their details. The technical study does **not** need to be recorded.

3. Authentication

A signed authentication form indicating that the work has been supervised and is the student's own must be submitted.

Note: The presentation of the scores and recording is not assessed, but students are reminded of the importance of clear and orderly presentation.

*The word 'score' refers to any of the following: a full score in conventional staff notation; a lead sheet or chord chart; track sheets; tables or diagrams.